(8) this *ancient land* attains its rightful and honoured place in the world and make its full and willing contribution to the promotion of world peace and the welfare of mankind [emphasis added].

Clearly, the framers of the Constitution expressly acknowledged that they were not founding a hitherto non-existent country, but were, in fact, putting together a statist apparatus for an ancient civilisation of which they were descendants. In fact, there is nothing in the Constituent Assembly debates that suggests that the framers of the Constitution operated under the belief that Bharat was a synthetic product of colonial efforts or that Bharat owed its very existence to the Constitution. In other words, there is no basis for the colonialised myth that Bharat was created by the British coloniser prior to which it lacked a sense of self and history.

With regard to the use of 'India that is Bharat' in Article 1 of the Constitution, for the limited purposes of the specific discussion at hand, let us start from the point where the Draft Constitution prepared by the Drafting Committee[19] was taken up for a clause-by-clause debate by the Constituent Assembly for the first time on 15 November 1948, after the Draft Constitution was presented to the Assembly on 4 November 1948. The Draft Article 1 of the Draft Constitution read as follows:

1. (1) *India* shall be a Union of States.
(2) The States shall mean the States for the time being specified in Parts I, II and III of the First Schedule.
(3) The territory of India shall comprise-
(a) The territories of the States;
(b) The territories for the time being specified in Part IV of the First Schedule; and
(c) Such other territories as may be acquired [emphasis added].

The said Article was considered and debated in the Constituent Assembly on 15 November 1948, 17 November 1948, 17 September 1949 and 18 September 1949. From the debates of 15 November 1948, following are the relevant excerpts on the amendments proposed to the Draft Article 1 on the issue of naming of the country[20]:

ARTICLE 1.